

MOCK TEST 📅

Automated Negotiation

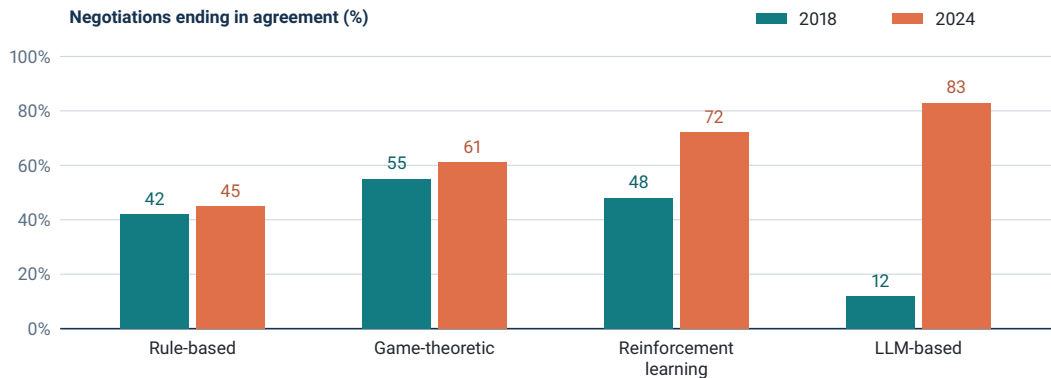
Academic Module · Writing (60 min) · Speaking (11–14 min)

01**WRITING TASK 1 · 20 minutes · at least 150 words**

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The bar chart below shows the percentage of automated business negotiations that ended in an agreement, by the type of software agent used, in **2018** and **2024**.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.

**WRITING TASK 2 · 40 minutes · at least 250 words**

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task. Write about the following topic:

In many industries, negotiations that were once carried out by people are now handled by computer programs acting on their behalf.

Do the advantages of this development outweigh the disadvantages?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

SPEAKING · Parts 1–3**Part 1 – Introduction & interview** (4–5 min)

Topic: *Studies & teamwork*

- 1 What subject are you studying at the moment, and why did you choose it?
- 2 Do you prefer working on projects alone or in a team? Why?
- 3 How often do you have to make compromises with classmates or colleagues?
- 4 Is it easy for you to say “no” to other people’s requests?

Part 2 – Long turn (1 min prep + 2 min)

Describe a time when you had to negotiate to reach an agreement with someone.

You should say:

- ▶ who you negotiated with
 - ▶ what the disagreement was about
 - ▶ how you reached an agreement
- and explain how you felt about the final outcome.

Part 3 – Two-way discussion (4–5 min)

- 1 Why do some people find negotiating uncomfortable, while others enjoy it?
- 2 Should negotiation skills be taught formally at school? Why/why not?
- 3 How might cultural differences affect the way people bargain?
- 4 Would you trust an AI agent to negotiate a salary or a contract for you?
- 5 What could go wrong if two AI systems negotiated with each other without human oversight?
- 6 In the future, which kinds of agreements do you think will always need a human touch?

MOCK TEST

Data Science in Higher Education

Academic Module · Writing (60 min) · Speaking (11–14 min)

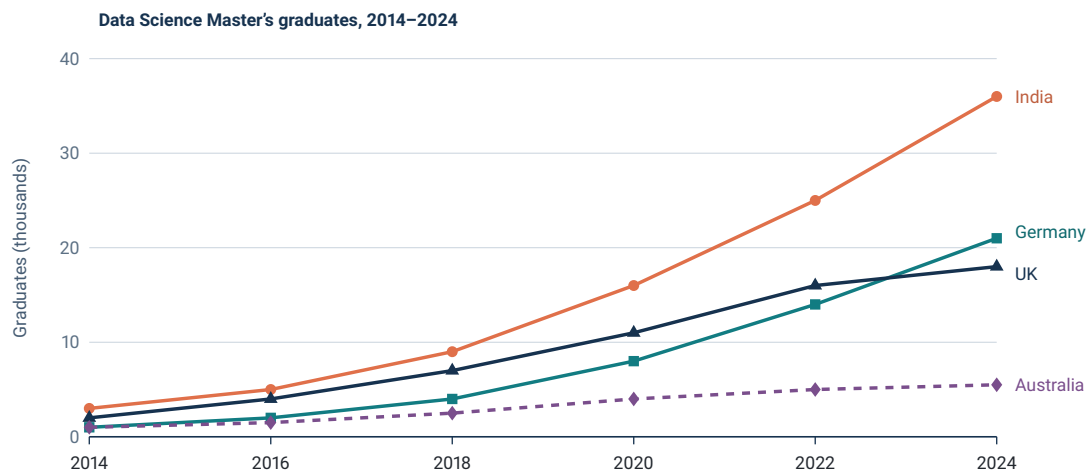
02

WRITING TASK 1 · 20 minutes · at least 150 words

You should spend about 20 minutes on this task.

The line graph below shows the number of students graduating from **Master's programmes in Data Science** in four countries between **2014** and **2024**.

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant.



WRITING TASK 2 · 40 minutes · at least 250 words

You should spend about 40 minutes on this task. Write about the following topic:

Some people believe that universities should concentrate on practical, job-ready skills such as programming and data analysis. Others argue that universities should prioritise deep theoretical knowledge.

Discuss both these views and give your own opinion.

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

SPEAKING · Parts 1–3

Part 1 – Introduction & interview (4–5 min)

Topic: Technology & numbers

- Which app or website do you use most often each day?
- Were you good at mathematics when you were a child?
- Do you enjoy reading charts and statistics in the news? Why?
- Has technology made your studies easier or more stressful?

Part 2 – Long turn (1 min prep + 2 min)

Describe a piece of research or a project you are proud of.

You should say:

- what the project was about
 - who you worked with
 - what difficulties you faced
- and explain why you are proud of it.

Part 3 – Two-way discussion (4–5 min)

- Why do you think data-related jobs have become so popular recently?
- Should governments fund pure research that has no obvious practical use?
- How can ordinary people tell whether a statistic in the media is reliable?
- Is it fair that companies collect so much personal data from their users?
- Will artificial intelligence make university degrees less valuable?
- How should researchers from different countries share data and credit fairly?

EXAMINER'S TOOLKIT

Band Criteria, Model Language & Self-Check

Use this page after each mock to mark yourself honestly.

HOW YOU ARE MARKED · Writing (each criterion = 25%)

Criterion	Band 7 looks like...	Band 8–9 looks like...
Task Achievement / Response	Clear overview (T1); position is clear throughout (T2)	Well-selected key features; fully developed, extended ideas
Coherence & Cohesion	Logical paragraphing; a range of linkers, occasionally overused	Cohesion is “invisible”; paragraphing is skilful
Lexical Resource	Some less common items; occasional collocation errors	Wide, precise, natural vocabulary; rare slips only
Grammatical Range & Accuracy	Frequent error-free sentences; varied structures	Wide range; the majority of sentences error-free

★ **Model overview – Mock 1, Task 1**

Overall, every type of agent reached agreement more often in 2024 than in 2018, but the scale of improvement varied dramatically. The most striking change was in LLM-based agents, which rose from being by far the least successful (12%) to the most successful (83%), whereas rule-based systems remained almost static at just under half.

Language bank – trends & data

Rise: surge, soar, climb steadily, a sharp/threefold increase
Fall: decline, dip, plummet, a marginal decrease
Stable: plateau, level off, remain virtually unchanged
Compare: outstrip, lag behind, twice as many as, by contrast
Approximate: just under a half, roughly a third, nearly

★ **Model thesis – Mock 2, Task 2**

While job-ready skills undeniably help graduates enter the labour market, I would argue that theory is what allows them to stay employable once today's tools become obsolete; therefore the best degrees integrate the two rather than choose between them.

Language bank – negotiation & AI

Nouns: concession, trade-off, stakeholder, consensus, leverage, dead-lock, mutual gain
Verbs: bargain, compromise, mediate, reach/strike a deal, reconcile interests
AI terms: autonomous agent, algorithmic bias, accountability, transparency, human-in-the-loop
Hedging: it could be argued that, to a certain extent, arguably

Timing plan

T1: 3 plan · 14 write · 3 check
T2: 5 plan · 30 write · 5 check
Speaking P2: jot 4–5 key words, not sentences

Self-check before you stop writing

☐ T1 has a clear overview paragraph (no opinions!)

☐ Key numbers are compared, not just listed

☐ T2 answers every part of the question

☐ Each body paragraph has one main idea + example

☐ Word count: T1 ≥ 150, T2 ≥ 250

☐ Checked articles, plurals and subject–verb agreement

SPEAKING BOOSTERS · Fluency, vocabulary & pronunciation

Extend every answer: A – R – E

Answer directly → give a Reason → add an Example.
“I’d trust an AI agent with routine deals, (A) because it can compare thousands of offers without getting tired or emotional. (R) For instance, some energy companies already let algorithms bargain over electricity prices every few minutes.” (E)

Five Band-6 traps to avoid

- Describing every number in Task 1 instead of grouping trends.
- Memorised openers (“Nowadays, with the development of...”).
- Giving an opinion in Task 1 or none at all in Task 2.
- One-word or one-sentence answers in Speaking Part 1.
- Using fillers (“like”, “you know”) instead of pausing naturally.

Score tracker	TA/TR	CC	LR	GRA	Overall
Mock 1	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Mock 2	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____